

The Warp Zone

Press Start to Consult: the night-before cheat sheet.

BOOK 1 OF 3



01 HUD CHECK

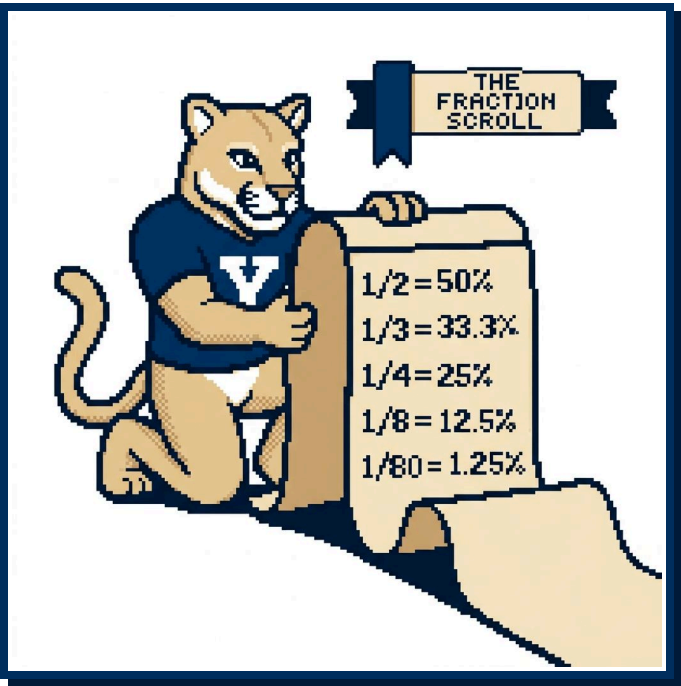
- 1 Opening Cutscene and Save Point (about 1 minute).** Take notes, then recap out loud: client, goal, numbers confirmed. Over video, 60 and 16 sound alike.
- 2 Dialogue Tree (2 to 3 minutes).** Ask three to five questions: business model, scope, target metric, gaps in your notes. Put a dodged question in your map.
- 3 Pause Menu, then Quest Map (2 minutes head down, about 3 to deliver).** Ask for two minutes each time. The coaches said any trained Player 2 expects it. Draw four regions with three quantified quests each, then renumber them by priority.
- 4 The variable middle.** Expect Number Cruncher rounds (about 2 minutes to structure, 3 to solve and share) and Idea Hydra rounds (3 to 4 minutes), in any number and any order.
- 5 Final Boss: The Chairlift (about 1 minute).** Ask for 30 seconds, then deliver a one-sentence recap, the recommendation before its support, the least-supported assumption, and next steps.

02 SPELLBOOK

- **Add:** line up the zeros, add from the left, say each subtotal out loud.
- **Subtract:** round the number you are taking away up to a clean figure, subtract, then add back what you over-subtracted: 500 minus 198 is 500 minus 200, plus 2, so 302.
- **Multiply:** strip the zeros, multiply the small numbers, put the zeros back: 400K units times \$150 is 4 times 15, then six zeros, \$60M.

- **Divide:** factor the divisor: 84K divided by 6 is half of 84K, then a third, about 14K.
- **Big numbers:** carry the unit (K, M, B, T). Thousands times thousands make millions.
- **Percents:** find 10% by moving the decimal, then scale: 15% is 10% plus half of it.

THE FRACTION SCROLL	
FRACTION	PERCENT
1/2	50%
1/3	33.3%
1/4	25%
1/5	20%
1/6	16.7%
1/7	14.3%
1/8	12.5%
1/9	11.1%
1/10	10%
1/11	9.1%
1/12	8.3%
1/15	6.7%
1/20	5%
1/25	4%
1/30	3.3%
1/40	2.5%
1/50	2%
1/80	1.25%
1/100	1%



The 1/80 trick. Give an 80-year lifespan an even spread and each year of age holds 1.25% of the population. People 65 and over span 15 years: 15 times 1.25% is about 19%. K-12 spans 13 grades: 13 times 1.25% is about 16%. The Atlas figures run lower (60M and 50M), so use the trick for a first pass and the Atlas for the final number.

THREE ROUNDING TRICKS.

☐

Round inputs to clean divisors and say so: Germany's 84M becomes 80M, and 3.5M Utahns at 3.0 per home become 1.2M households.

☐

Round one factor up and the other down so the errors offset: 48 times 21 becomes 50 times 20, or 1,000 (true: 1,008).☐

03 OVERWORLD ATLAS

Carry these in your head: US population, your city, the interview city, two countries or a continent, and your target firm's sector headline. Ask Player 2 for the rest.

WORLD AND US

FIGURE	VALUE
World population	8.2B
World GDP	\$120T
US population	340M
US households	130M
US average household size	2.5
US adults 18+	260M
US 65+	60M
US K-12 students	50M
US GDP	\$30T

UTAH	
FIGURE	VALUE
Utah population	3.5M
Utah households	1.2M
Utah average household size	3.0
Wasatch Front population	2.7M
Salt Lake County	1.2M
Utah County	720K
Provo-Orem metro	780K
BYU total enrollment	34K

REGIONS	
REGION	POP.
Asia	4.8B
Africa	1.5B
Europe	745M
European Union	450M
North America (US, Canada, Mexico)	510M

TEN BIGGEST US METROS	
METRO	POP.
New York metro	20M
Los Angeles metro	13M
Chicago metro	9.5M
Dallas-Fort Worth metro	8M
Houston metro	7.5M

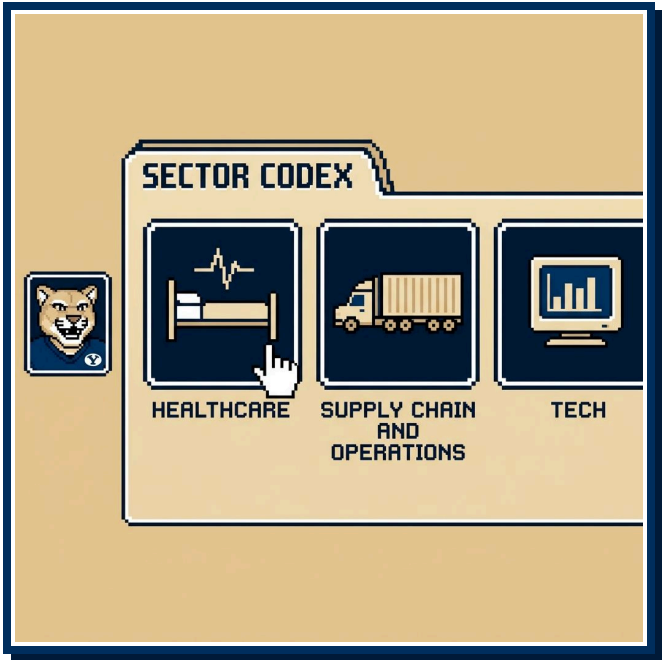
TEN BIGGEST US METROS, CONTINUED	
METRO	POP.
San Francisco Bay Area	7.5M
Washington DC metro	6.3M
Atlanta metro	6.3M
Miami metro	6.2M
Philadelphia metro	6.2M

TWELVE COUNTRIES	
COUNTRY	POP.
India	1.44B
China	1.41B
United States	340M
Indonesia	280M
Brazil	215M
Mexico	130M

TWELVE COUNTRIES, CONTINUED	
COUNTRY	POP.
Japan	124M
Germany	84M
United Kingdom	68M
France	68M
Canada	40M
Australia	28M

04 SECTOR CODEX

Load the page that matches your firm. A healthcare firm expects you to know Medicare enrollees cold.



HEALTHCARE	
METRIC	FIGURE
US healthcare spending	\$5.3T
Healthcare share of US GDP	18%
Spending per person	\$15.5K
US hospitals	6,100
Medicare enrollees	68M
Medicaid and CHIP enrollees	72M
Employer insurance covered lives	155M
Hospital operating margin	1% to 4%

SUPPLY CHAIN AND OPERATIONS	
METRIC	FIGURE
Logistics cost share of US GDP	9%
Trucking share of freight tonnage	72%
Truckload capacity (weight)	45,000 lb
Truckload capacity (pallets)	26 pallets
Truckload rate per mile	\$2.50
Ocean transit, Shanghai to LA	14 to 21 days
Last-mile share of total delivery cost	40% to 50%
Inventory carrying cost	20% to 30%
Fill rate target	95% to 98%
OEE world class	85%

TECH	
METRIC	FIGURE
Software gross margin	70% to 85%
LTV to CAC benchmark	3x
CAC payback benchmark	under 18 months
Net revenue retention (good)	100% to 120%
Annual gross churn, healthy SaaS	5% to 10%
Rule of 40	growth % + profit margin % >= 40
Marketplace take rate	10% to 30%
E-commerce share of US retail	16%

05 QUEST MAP IN 60 SECONDS

Build the four regions from this prompt, quantify each quest, and attach a "so that." Use your Compass, the hypothesis, to pick the region you start in.

- **Profitability:** Revenue (price, volume, mix), Cost (fixed, variable). Split each into external causes (demand, competitor moves) and internal causes (capacity, recent changes) with no overlap. Add what you suspect, such as a rival's price cut.
- **Market entry:** Market attractiveness (size, growth, share concentration), Customer (segments, willingness to pay, channel), Entry economics (price, margin, investment, payback), Capabilities and entry mode (build, partner, buy).
- **Growth:** Market, Product, Customer, Company. Or run the product-market matrix, current or new product by current or new market, and size each cell.
- **M&A:** Standalone value of the target, Synergies (revenue and cost, each sized), Deal economics (price against value, payback), Risks (culture, regulators, key people). Close with a binary answer: buy or pass.
- **Pricing:** Cost floor (unit economics), Customer ceiling (willingness to pay, elasticity), Competitor reference prices, Strategy and channel (skim or penetrate, dealer margin).
- **Operations:** Map the process, find the bottleneck, then Cost per unit, Capacity and utilization, Quality and waste, Speed (cycle time, on-time-in-full delivery).
- **The Sizing Dungeon, five floors:** (1) population, households, or businesses, (2) three or four segments, (3) percent who own or buy, (4) purchase frequency, under one per year for durables, (5) average price. True up 10% to 20% for fleets, rentals, and businesses. Market size means revenue per year unless Player 2 says otherwise. Utah e-bikes, all brands (the Wasatch Wheels case): 1.2M households, 72K on the Wasatch Front plus 12K rural for 84K, 14K a year, 16.8K with fleets, \$33.6M.

06 BOSS CHECKLISTS

BOSS FIGHT I: THE NUMBER CRUNCHER

- ☐ Recap the data, confirm each number, and name the unit: units or dollars.
- ☐ Write the equation in words before any number and get Player 2's nod.
- ☐ Solve out loud, one step at a time, and sense-check each result.
- ☐ Give the three-part answer: the number, the Loot (what it means and what the client should do), and what is next.

BOSS FIGHT II: THE IDEA HYDRA

- ☐ Recap the narrower question in 30 seconds, then ask for 30 to 60 seconds of prep.
- ☐ Name three necks that do not overlap (about 1 minute).
- ☐ Hang two to four heads on each neck.
- ☐ Say where you would start and what else (30 seconds).

FINAL BOSS: THE CHAIRLIFT

- ☐ Recap why the client called and what you found across the whole case.
- ☐ Recommend: a binary answer to a binary question, the support, and the least-supported assumption.
- ☐ Name three next steps, deeper or wider, starting with the one that firms up that assumption.

GAME OVER FIVE GAME OVER SCREENS

- ☐ You counted the installed base, a stock, instead of annual sales, a flow.
- ☐ You assumed 100% ownership, or any figure you cannot defend when Player 2 asks "why 60%?"
- ☐ You did the math in silence, or before the nod.
- ☐ You skipped the Pause Menu, or rambled past three minutes on the Quest Map.
- ☐ You handed over a number with no Loot, or called your dodged question dumb.

CONTINUE? ► YES NO

Each screen ends with **Continue?**, and the answer is one more live case out loud.

